

Identifying sounds

Aim:

For the child to be able to hear the difference between sounds.

This task focuses on the child learning to hear the difference between sounds. It also encourages them to watch your mouth to see how you make different sounds.

Resources:

- Sound cards- make your own on card/paper.
- Building blocks/animals/game pieces/bean bags/hoola hoops, depending on the activity chosen.



How to complete the activity:

1. Choose two sounds to focus on and either cut out or make your own picture cards to represent the sounds.
2. Place the pictures in front of the child, tell them what sound each of the cards make.
3. Now, say one of the sounds and ask your child to point or place an item, (e.g. brick or counter) on the card on the sound that they hear. Encourage them to watch your mouth as you make the sound.
4. Continue doing this, saying each of the sounds in a random order so that the child doesn't learn the pattern.
5. If your child puts a brick/counter on the sound card, model the sound again and place it on to the correct picture.
6. Once your child is confident hearing the difference between the two sounds, choose another two sounds. Continue working through the sounds in this manner.

Activity Ideas:

Brick Towers: Place two sound card on the table and give your child some bricks. Name one of the pictures. The child puts a brick on the sound they hear. How tall will the tower get?.....

Post boxes: Cut slots in two shoe boxes to make post boxes and cut rectangles to be the letters to post. Stick a sound card on each. The child listens and posts a letter in the right box.

Skittles: Set up two skittles and stick a sound card on each one. The child listens while you say the sound and rolls their ball at the one they think you said.

Lily Pads and Frogs: Cut out cardboard discs to look like lily-pads and place the sound cards on them. Give your child a toy frog and ask them to make their frog jump on the correct lily-pad by listening to you as you say the sound.

Run to the corner: Place sound cards in opposite corners of the room. Encourage your child to listen while you say one of the sounds. They must race to the sound they hear.

Stepping-Stones: Cut out some paper or cardboard discs the size of dinner plates. Lay them on the floor and stick the sound cards on them. The child has to listen to hear how to cross the river by jumping on the sound you say.

Jump in the circle: Place a hula-hoop on the floor or draw a circle with chalk on the ground. Place a sound card in each circle and ask the child to jump in the circle that has the sound you say.

Bean bags in buckets: Stick sound cards on buckets. The child has to listen to find out which bucket to throw their bean bag into.

Turn-taking game: Use the sound cards alongside a game, for example pop up pirate – place a sword on each of the sound cards, say one of the sounds, then the child can take a turn at the game.

Hide a penny: Ask the child to close their eyes and hide a penny under one of the sound cards, then tell your child which sound to look under so they find the coin.